

Communications Audit Report for Vanier Children's Mental Wellness

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ISSUED BY

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Table of Contents

Executive Summary.....	2
Introduction.....	3
Audit	
Process.....	4
Review and Recommendations.....	5
Website.....	
5	
Review.....	5
Recommendations.....	8
Social Media.....	10
Review.....	10
Recommendations.....	11
Advertorials and Public Advertising.....	12
Review.....	12
Recommendations.....	13
Strategic Plan and Communications	
Strategy.....	15
Review.....	15

Recommendations.....16

Conclusions.....1

6

Appendices.....18

Executive Summary

The goal of this communications audit was to analyze and evaluate the communication methods employed by Vanier Children’s Mental Wellness to provide recommendations on how to better reach their target audiences and accomplish their communication objectives. It consists of an introduction, a description of the audit process, a review and recommendations, and a conclusion. The reviews and recommendations are the most significant part of the audit, composed of four sections based on the communication products analyzed. These products include Vanier’s website, social media presence, recent public advertising and advertorials, as well as their new strategic plan and its associated communications strategy.

Our recommendations for the website include making site content more concise and audience-oriented by implementing key message best practices. Suggestions for improving site navigation and user experience have also been shared. Social media recommendations include making graphics less text-heavy and moving copywriting to the caption to increase searchable keywords, keeping a consistent brand identity across platforms and using LinkedIn to attract donors. Public advertising and advertorial recommendations include lowering word count on

graphics, displaying actual client photos instead of stock images and developing a greater focus on client success stories for advertorials. It is also recommended that Vanier create social media campaigns, such as hashtags tied in with their advertisements and advertorials. As for the strategic plan and communications strategy, we provide various recommendations including hiring the services of a language agency and enacting metrics to measure communications outcomes.

Introduction

[Vanier Children's Mental Wellness](#) is an accredited nonprofit that has been providing mental health services for children in the London-Middlesex area for over 50 years. Their goal, as stated in their mission statement, is to provide culturally responsive and accessible mental health services for children, youths and families. Vanier also prides itself on being a system leader and promoting improved care in their community as the [Lead Agency](#) for youth mental health services in the London-Middlesex service area. They are accredited by the [Canadian Centre for Accreditation](#) and are members of the [Pillar Nonprofit Network](#), [Children's Mental Health Ontario](#) and the [London Clinical Psychology Residency Consortium](#).

Vanier has two target audiences: clients and donors. Regarding the client audience, the organization communicated an eagerness to reach newcomer and marginalized families to address the evolving needs of a diverse and growing London. Vanier's current communications approach is threefold: a website paid advertisements and five social media pages. In terms of communication objectives, Vanier wants to increase its visibility and establish trust with their client audience – that is, it has an effect on awareness and acceptance. As for the donor audience, Vanier's communication objectives involve attracting more donors and fostering stronger relationships with them — hence, they seek to affect their awareness and behaviour.

In addition to their communications efforts, Vanier has collected data from their clients, staff and key stakeholders, and formulated a new strategic plan this past year. This is a good

starting point to gauge the effectiveness of the current communications strategies in place. Nonetheless, targeted primary research and collection of data from the key audiences — donors and clients — will also be useful.

Audit Process

The audit process began with a meeting with Kelly Simpson, Vanier's executive director, alongside executive assistant Sherri Simms. The discussion touched upon the organization's business goals and objectives, communications strategy and target audiences. There were two key takeaways from this meeting: their audiences and their lack of a communications team.

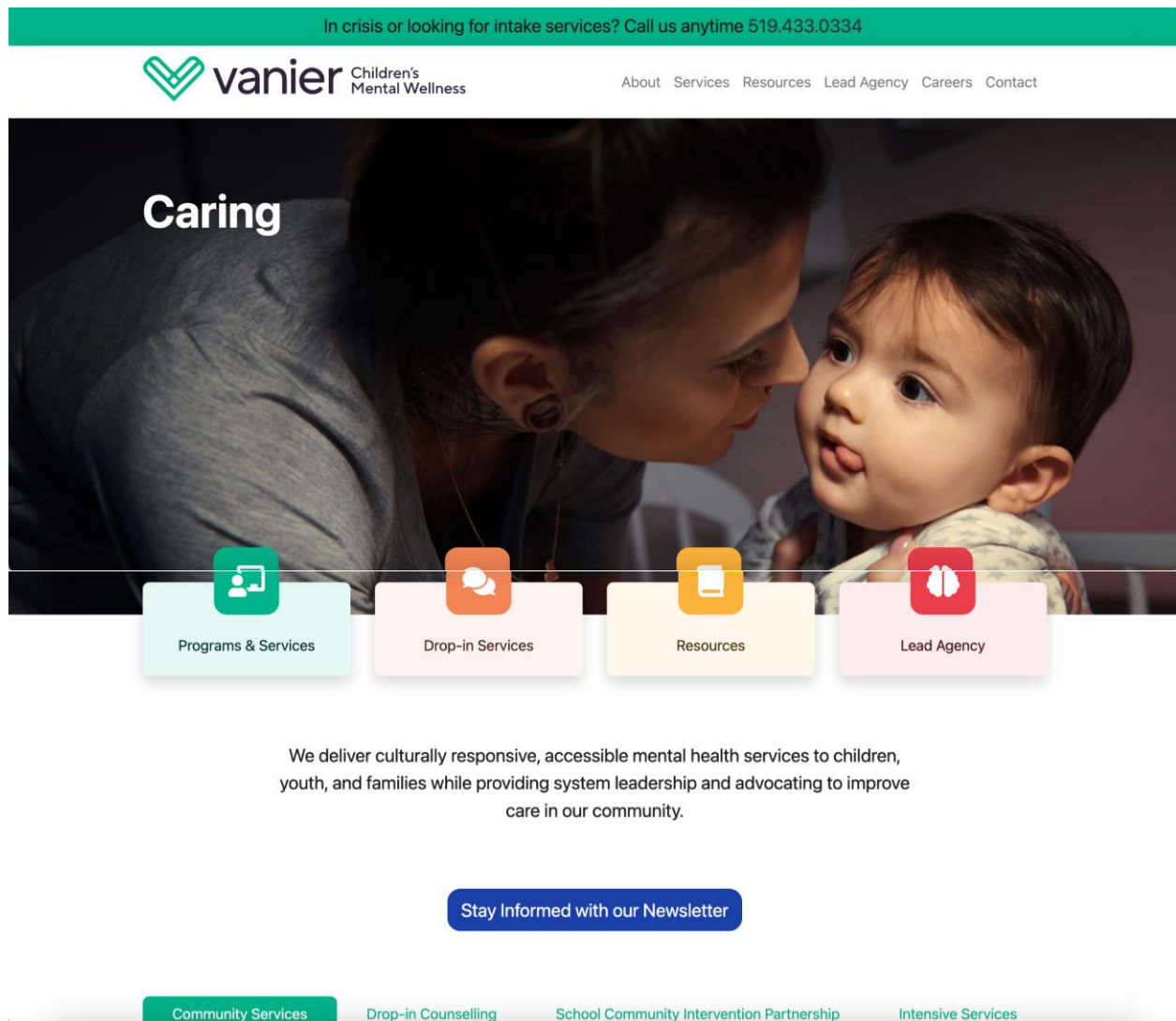
Firstly, Vanier has two distinct target audiences: donors and clients. These audiences have different characteristics and needs and thus are targeted in different ways. They also mentioned a desire to target London's growing newcomer population and, overall, clients from marginalized groups with an equity-informed lens. The second takeaway was that, in the absence of a full-time communications team, Vanier struggles to devote the needed time to communications strategy and hasn't seen a great return on investment for their recent campaigns.

The communications review was subsequently divided into four sections to observe the strengths and weaknesses of Vanier's most recent communication products, including their: website, social media strategy, public advertisements and advertorials, and strategic plan and communications strategy. One group member was assigned to each of these products to review who is being targeted and what is or isn't working in terms of messaging, strategy and approach. The recommendation sections outline actionable steps the organization can take to strengthen their communications approach in reaching both target audiences.

Review and Recommendations

Website

Review



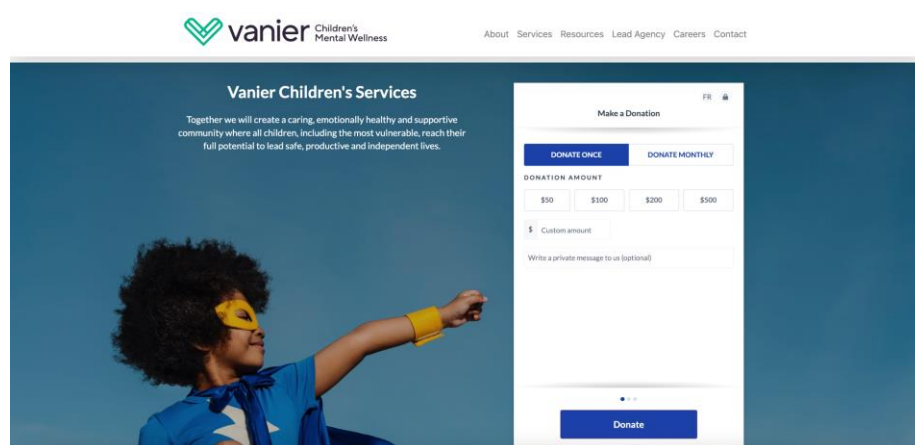
Screenshot of Vanier's website landing page

Vanier's website is clearly built with the client audience — that is, families with young children in need of mental health services — in mind. In terms of critiques, the website home page is weakened by information overload, redundancy and a lack of user-friendliness. For instance, the Resources and Lead Agency buttons in the main site menu lead to the same

pages as those in the sub-menu. Similarly, the Programs & Services button in the sub-menu leads to the same page as the Services button in the main site menu. The redundancy of the two site menus make the site difficult to navigate for new page visitors, who are unlikely to know the difference — or lack of difference — between the pages each button leads to. This makes it more time-consuming and less intuitive to familiarize oneself with Vanier’s services and decide if they’re suitable for the visitor’s needs.

That said, one of the home page’s strengths is the brief descriptions of services — “Community Services,” “Drop-in Counseling,” “School Community Intervention Partnership” and “Intensive Services” — the tabs for which can be seen at the bottom of the screenshot above. These descriptions bring tangibility to the variety of services at Vanier within the first minute of a site session. However, the descriptions are very broad, and they do not direct visitors to further information about each offering. This is a missed opportunity for designing the site with a customized user experience in mind, given the broad variety of clients and needs served at Vanier. Also, these service tabs do not stand out given all of the information stored above them, their small font size and their lack of heading.

As for how the website targets Vanier’s donor audience, this banner (right) is the only part of the site that invites donations, and it is placed near the bottom of every page on the



site. In terms of strengths, it is a cute image that evokes positive feelings of youth empowerment. There is an evident effort at inclusion and representation of marginalized groups in both the image choice and the caption. That said, placing this banner on every page of the

website — rather than a context which specifically targets donors — is not the most strategic choice as it gets lost beneath the rest of the content and likely gets viewed by the wrong eyes. A parent looking into Vanier’s services is not the ideal person to be asking for donations, yet they are shown this banner regardless of which page they’re viewing. Moreover, the messaging lacks strategy. Where they have written “Vanier Children’s Services” could instead be a call-to-action for donations, and the caption underneath should be a specific, concise message written with donors in mind — for example, which states how their donation can make a difference.

This brings us to a brief review of the key messages on Vanier’s website. Key messages are the phrases that sum up an organization’s work, priorities or values which are reiterated within and across platforms in hopes that they will be retained by the audience they are written for. Here are some key messages identified across Vanier’s website:

1. We deliver culturally responsive, accessible mental health services to children, youth, and families while providing system leadership and advocating to improve care in our community. (via [home page](#); [Mission, Vision & Values](#); [Vanier’s Brochure](#)).
2. We support children 0-14 years, and their families, through individualized treatment plans based on comprehensive assessments of each child’s strengths and areas of need. (via [Resources](#))
3. Vanier Children’s Mental Wellness serves as Lead Agency for the London-Middlesex service area. (via [Lead Agency](#))

One strength of these key messages is their consistency across the site. However, it’s difficult to grasp exactly what Vanier’s services entail because those services are so broad. Key messages need to be clear, concise, specific, and written with their audience in mind. Also, while there is an abundance of messages targeted at clients, the only message targeted at donors is the sentence in the donation banner mentioned above.

Recommendations

To fix the user-friendliness and redundancy problems, Vanier should add a drop-down function to the main site menu — see Appendix 1 for an example. This would apply to the “Services,” “About,” “Resources” and “Careers” tabs as these all have sub-pages housed within them. Drop-down site menus are the most efficient way to glance at all the information on a site and dictate its usefulness to the site visitor. By implementing this, the sub-menu beneath the image carousel could be removed, reducing the redundancy and navigation problem. We also recommend updating or removing the statistics on clients and staff on the homepage, as they add little value to the crowded page while illustrating an outdated pandemic-era context.

Also, to improve site navigation, the four tabs beneath Vanier’s mission statement, which describe the organization’s different service offerings, should enable viewers to learn more about the services that apply to them. We recommend linking these tabs to the site pages on each service. That way, if the brief description of, say Community Services resonates with the site visitor, a click on that tab’s title would take them to the full page on [Community Services](#). Lastly, the service description tabs should be made to stand out more — they do summarize the essence of Vanier’s existence, after all. This can be done by increasing their font size and introducing them with a heading, such as “Our Services at a Glance,” for example.

To better target their donor audience, Vanier could add a new page to the site menu called “Donate” — partner organizations such as [Boys & Girls Club of London](#), [Merrymount](#) and [St. Leonard’s](#) feature examples. It is better not to solicit donations on the same pages where potential clients seek out information on the help they need.

Finally, to strengthen Vanier’s strategic messaging across its website, we recommend implementing key message best practices. This entails phrases that are clear and concise, active in tone and written with their audience in mind, positive and proactive in nature, and short and specific. Consider the difference between these phrases:

We support children 0-14 years, and their families, through individualized treatment plans based on comprehensive assessments of each child's strengths and areas of need.

And:

We support the mental health and wellness of children aged 0-14 through comprehensive assessments and individualized treatment plans.

The breadth of Vanier's service offerings also call for added talking points to some key messages, which are used to add context, supporting facts and statistics (where applicable).

The key message above could benefit from added context such as:

We service a wide variety of needs, with programs ranging from [community services](#) like [family therapy](#) and [respite](#), to [intensive services](#) such as [live-in treatment](#).

It is also good practice to hyperlink other pages within a website when mentioning things that are explained in further detail elsewhere — as has been exemplified above. This allows readers to learn more about the services that apply to them without needing to search for it.

The final key message recommendation pertains to targeting donors. Whether it is on the existing donations banner or on a new Donate page, the key message best practices outlined above should also be implemented. The only current donor-targeted message is:

Together we will create a caring, emotionally healthy and supportive community where all children, including the most vulnerable, reach their full potential to lead safe, productive and independent lives.

Here is a proposed revision:

Your support helps us create a caring community where all children are empowered to lead healthy, happy and independent lives.

This revision says the same thing in fewer words, while clearly targeting a prospective donor in an active, hopeful manner.

Social Media

Review

Vanier's social media consists of [Facebook](#), [Twitter](#), [Instagram](#), [LinkedIn](#) and [YouTube](#) pages. Their Facebook account has almost 50 per cent of their total social media following across platforms — 816 of 1,695 as of Nov. 27, 2023. It's unclear whether their YouTube account has subscribers. Vanier posts to their Facebook most consistently, which has most likely led to a higher follower count. Their Facebook also has a range of posts, including sharing their own graphics, photos and videos, as well as resharing City of London and other London-area posts relating to youth mental wellness. Their Twitter and LinkedIn pages also post a range of content, but not as often or as much.

The major weaknesses in Vanier's social media strategy include their graphics posts, its brand identity on Twitter and YouTube, and their LinkedIn content strategy. The most significant issue with Vanier's social media content is their graphics posts. Their graphics are too text-heavy and often include a full URL that cannot be accessed unless a user manually writes it in their browser, which is evident in Appendix 2. These posts also do not have any captions, which means the content isn't searchable — keywords in the graphic won't show up in search results.

Vanier's brand identity on Twitter/X and YouTube is also different than on their other social media pages. Twitter has the username @VanierKids and features the name "Vanier" as the name of the account, with no mention of Vanier Children's Mental Wellness. YouTube has a similar problem, as the account handle is @vanieradmin6446, the name of the account is Vanier Admin and the profile image is different from all other pages and has a different colour scheme — again, with no mention of Vanier Children's Mental Wellness. These problems make it more challenging for their audiences to find their account and content on these platforms.

Vanier's social media strategy on LinkedIn should also be improved to attract their donor audience. There isn't much of a difference between their content across platforms, which means

their LinkedIn content isn't being targeted specifically to donors — it's unlikely their client audience will be looking at LinkedIn for mental wellness resources.

Recommendations

Vanier's social media graphics should be less text-heavy, and links should not be put on the graphics. It is recommended that they use the caption space to write all the content currently shown inside the graphic. Not only will this make their visuals more appealing, but it will also allow Vanier to be more searchable — users can find their content using keywords found in their posts — and URLs more accessible and more likely to be engaged with. According to data from [Agorapulse](#), image posts with no text do better than image posts with text. If text is necessary, be concise and keep it simple. Vanier could also consider the use of carousels: multi-photo posts instead of one large image with multiple graphics and heavy text.

Twitter and YouTube should also undergo profile updates. This would include making the usernames and profile images consistent with the rest of their social media pages and ensuring Vanier Children's Mental Wellness is easily visible and searchable across platforms. This strategy should help to increase the organization's visibility on social media.

Vanier's LinkedIn page should be posting content different from the rest of their social media pages and should be posting more often — as often as their Facebook account. They should be using LinkedIn to attract their donor audience. A [LinkedIn research survey](#) found that 33 per cent of users are actively involved in monthly donations. Also, [Classy's platform data](#) found that LinkedIn converts the most users to donors among all social media platforms, with 42 per cent of research respondents saying they use LinkedIn to search for organizations to donate to. LinkedIn and donor-specific content would include anything that would communicate how donations are used, how much they receive in donations, how people can get involved in donations, what the organization's culture is like and who they are. Featuring staff in posts —

with consent — and what they do could be a more effective way to provide faces to the services being provided and create connections with both potential customers and donors.

A final recommendation for Vanier's social media strategy is to build a [style guide](#) or brand kit for all their pages so they can communicate their key messages more consistently. This would include using a site like Canva to create a consistent set of graphics templates, font types, illustrations and overall look to the brand on social media. If a Canva Pro subscription does not fit into the budget, a simple copy and paste for each new free template would work. Not only will the organization's posts become more visually appealing to clients and donors, but it will also make social media posting more efficient as account administrators could just plug in content with a consistent template.

Advertorials and Public Advertising

Review

- Public Advertisements -

Vanier's advertisements are text-heavy and use generic stock images of a child or a family. The text typically includes statistics on children's mental health, followed by a paragraph outlining services provided. The NPO's logo sits at the top with their socials linked at the bottom. Vanier conducted a recruitment campaign in early 2023, creating several advertisements hosted on city buses, posted along billboards across the city and at recruitment stands in public locations like malls. It also included a broadcast advertisement. The audio contains three key messages: Vanier is the leader in children's mental wellness in the London-Middlesex area, a professional and safe environment to grow and the positions and services offered by the organization.

- Advertorials -

In this Comms Review, we have included two samples of Vanier's advertorials: news articles on who the organization is, their location, what they do and partner organizations. The articles provide a succinct overview of the organization's history, mission and values.

Article 1: Vanier Children's Mental Health Services, Mental Health Matters, 2022.

The introductory paragraph for this article provides the NPO's history, the second mentions their activities and their targeted demographic, as well as providing a generalized list of services. The remainder of the article focuses on specific programs and partnerships hosted by Vanier such as the School Community Intervention Partnership and Tele-Mental Health services, and their partnership with the London Health Sciences Centre.

Article 2: Vanier a Success Story, Mental Health Matters, 2021.

This advertorial focuses on a character and current client of Vanier, named Matt. The text details Matt's struggles with mental health complexities and provides information about their Intensive services, yet always connected to Matt's story. For example: "He felt that people did not like him, and he was not sure why. Matt was diagnosed with Autism Spectrum Disorder which allowed for *new treatment options* that matched his neurodevelopment needs, steering him and his family towards the right services."

Recommendations

- Public Advertisements -

Vanier's ads could improve in three general ways. Firstly by identifying their target audience and the key message they wish to communicate specifically. Ads must be more specific and must provide a pertinent message to the chosen public. For example, if you wish to reach out to those who are struggling as well as to their families, you could create a series of ads dedicated to the crisis line, coupled with a hashtag and a social media campaign.

Another possible strategy could be to use current campaigns tied to mental health, such as the CMHA's Mental Health Week, to create an advertisement campaign - or a series of ads,

specific to said event. In summary, ads must be more specific/tailored for a chosen and specific audience and would receive huge advantages from relating the ads to a larger and more organized/formal campaign.

A second recommendation would be to reduce the number of words in the text on the graphics. Brochures, pamphlets and other subsidiary forms of information can provide large blocks of text. Advertisements should be simple and contain a clear message that directs the audience to whatever product or service is being advertised through socials or website URLs.

The advert in Appendix 3, for example, contains key information: the stats listed at the beginning, and then it provides a number to call for those struggling to receive support. That info alone would be sufficient for the advert. Even a message as simple as say: Struggling with mental health? If you or someone..." Otherwise, any other information can be found through any socials, websites or addresses listed in the advertisement.

Conversely, Vanier's logo and colour scheme are recognizable and simple in design: a green V. In ads, this should and must be the symbol or element most predominantly displayed. Other ads, especially those tied to the same marketing campaign should follow similar colour schemes and design graphics - to maintain a recognizable uniformity.

For example, backpack company [JanSport ran a mental health campaign](#) in May of this year. The campaign was tied to the hashtag #LightenTheLoad and a series of videos detailing the experiences of students dealing with mental health issues. The key points to note here are that their ads were tied to a recognizable hashtag.



The final recommendation relates to the images and photos used in the ads. Each image used for #LightenTheLoad is a photo of an actual person interviewed for their video series. Advertisements and advertorials, like Matt's article, should similarly include photos of current or

previous clients — with consent — where possible. This would enhance the personability of Vanier to the London public and would also display the organization's “success story.”

- Advertorials -

Advertorials receive similar recommendations to the Public Ads in terms of graphics used and chosen, as well as the images displayed on the London Free Press's pages. The article titled “Vanier Success Story” is a great example of a piece that should be of focus. Vanier has a community-oriented goal to improve and support children's mental health, so character stories would allow the community to see a more personal example of Vanier's success.

Strategic Plan and Communications Strategy

Review

Vanier recently developed a new strategic plan for the next five years, which was submitted as a report in May 2023. In the report, Vanier provides four major goals within its strategic plan: improving mental health services through a child and family-centered lens; further engaging with community partners and assessing community needs to enhance the leadership position of Vanier; implementing the Equity, Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging framework by increasing engagement with minority and newcomer families alongside inclusive services and staff training; and finally, increasing employee engagement by fostering an inclusive and healthy work culture with the help of the EDIB framework and other training.

Vanier developed a communications strategy on how they would articulate this strategic plan to stakeholders. The internal section of this strategy deals with how best to inform the staff about the new communication policies and plans in place, whereas the external section is concerned with ensuring clients and donors are aware of the new plan.

Recommendations

Vanier's 2023 to 2027 strategic plan has various strong points. One recommendation with regard to the EDIB framework would be to engage the services of a language interpretation agency to add another language to the webpage. According to the latest data from Statistics Canada, Arabic, Spanish and Mandarin are the three languages most spoken in London after English and French. Adding at least one additional language option apart from the current English and French could be beneficial in reaching and retaining a broader audience.

It was a good idea to produce a comms plan for the articulation of the strategic plan to stakeholders. We recommend Vanier take up this practice more often. Perhaps for their next recruitment campaign, or even a targeted month-long effort to garner more donations, communication planning is crucial for attaining and measuring success whenever an organization wants to get a message out to their audience. All communication campaigns should be guided by a plan which outlines a purpose, target audience, concise key messages, channels on which to distribute those messages and a timeline for doing so.

Something that is lacking and essential is that Vanier develops strategies to measure the efficiency and effectiveness of their communication methods. This can be done by providing links to surveys on social media or through the various other communications channels already in place. This survey can serve as a measure to evaluate whether the information being distributed is resonating with the audience and increasing the organization's reach. In addition, it would be beneficial to include Key Performance Indicators such as new website visitors, the return rate to the website, referral visits, inbound links, and conversion rates. These KPIs would be subject to Vanier's preferences but should be based on stated quantifiable goals.

Conclusion

Vanier's website is thoughtfully designed with clients in mind and consistent key messages, but these messages should be revised to be more concise, active and specific. The

site could benefit from more hyperlinks to other site pages when the mention of a service does not provide full context. A comprehensive site menu with drop-down functions would also improve site navigation and thus, make it easier for clients to find information about the services they're looking for. The website could also benefit from a strategic effort to target donors.

Vanier's social media presence is strong on Facebook with range and post frequency, but falls short on cross-platform graphic design and consistency, as well as LinkedIn strategy. We recommend moving text from graphics to the caption to increase searchable keywords, keeping a consistent brand identity across platforms with a style guide and changing LinkedIn strategy to primarily speak to donors.

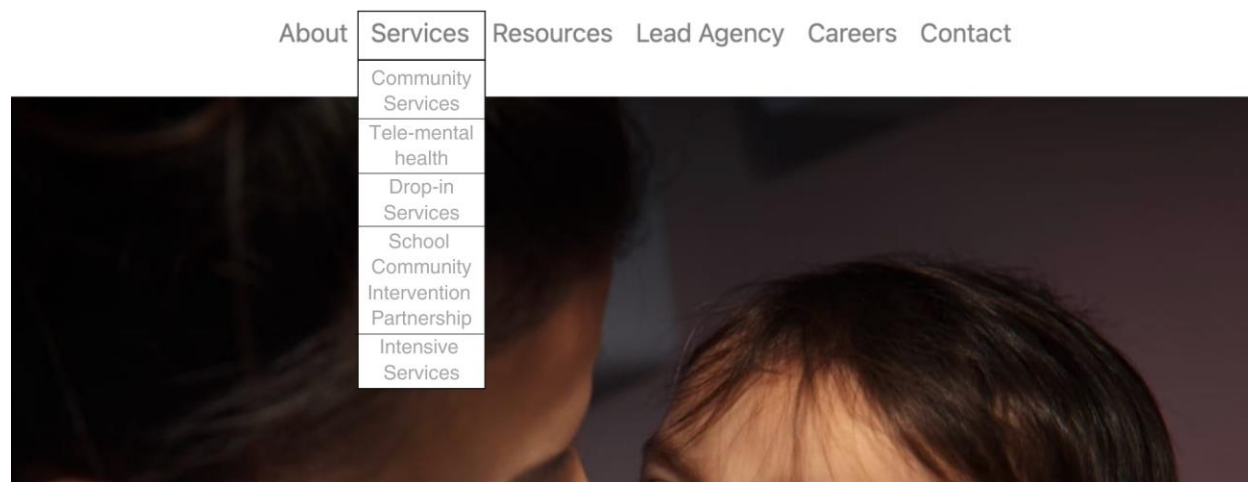
Most advertisements contain too much text and are overblown with information. Images used on these graphics are predominantly stock or royalty-free, and most ads lack a hashtag or social media tie-ins. Information is also often limited to a phone number or Vanier's website. Advertorials are well-written and present a professional organization. Vanier must ensure to lower their word count on ads, ensure uniformity of design and colour, display logos predominantly, display all forms of social media and resource access, use real images of client families and develop advertising campaigns tied to hashtags, resulting in more brand recognizability.

Finally, Vanier's Strategic Plan is well-formulated and includes measures on how to efficiently inform stakeholders and clients of its new policies and objectives. Nonetheless, Vanier is encouraged to develop scales of measurement as to the efficiency of the communications content being put out with the help of resources like surveys and KPIs. Moreover, the addition of language services and involvement with multicultural and immigrant-based organizations will also be beneficial in expanding Vanier's reach and adhering to the EDIB standards.

Appendices

Appendix 1: A visualized example of a hypothetical drop-down site menu.

for intake services? Call us anytime 519.433.0334



Appendix 2: August 2023 social media sample from Vanier, posted to their [Facebook](#)



Are you passionate about Children's Mental Health?

Do you want to make a difference
in your community?

Vanier Children's Mental Wellness is recruiting for our Board of Directors.

To apply or learn more please visit our website.
<https://www.vanier.com/about/board-executive-team/>

Appendix 3: Advertisement created by Vanier for centre awareness alongside their 2023 Mental Health Matters advertorial for the London Free Press. This ad was distributed both in print and online.



 **vanier** Children's
Mental Wellness

CARING. SUPPORTING. TRANSFORMING LIVES.

As many as **1 in 5** children & youth in Ontario will experience some form of mental health problem.

If you or someone you know needs help, contact our **Crisis and Intake Line** **519-433-0334**

The Crisis and Intake team coordinates the intake process for: **Vanier Children's Mental Wellness, Craigwood Children, Youth and Family Services, WAYS Mental Health Support**

To learn more about our programs and services, visit our website: **www.vanier.com**

FOLLOW US ON:  

Appendix 4: Advertorials paid for by Vanier, hosted on London Free Press

Mental Health Matters 2021 Special Feature

A Vanier Success Story

A VANIER SUCCESS STORY

Mat was referred to Vanier's Intensive Services Program to receive assessment and intensive treatment to address ongoing sensory and mental health challenges in the classroom. Mat had anxiety at school and had challenges socializing. His academic progress was delayed, and he was bullied by his peers. Mat is supported at home by his mother, who had tried various programs and supports to determine why her son struggled academically and socially.

The Intensive Services team consists of child and youth counselors, child and family therapists, teachers, psychologists, and psychiatrists. The team support and collaborate with children and families when they are involved in Vanier's treatment classrooms and live-in treatment programs.

Mat's inquisitive and curious nature made him gravitate towards finding out his interests. His anxiety was driving impulsive behaviour that made it difficult to relate to others. He felt that people did not like him, and he was not sure why. Mat was diagnosed with Autism Spectrum Disorder, which allowed for new treatment options that matched his neurodevelopmental needs, steering him and his family towards the right services.

Vanier worked closely with Mat and his mother to explore how his needs may look different when working with new treatment. A new perspective was beginning to unfold for this family and hope and opportunity began to shine through.

Mat began to feel better about himself, experienced less anxiety and began having positive interactions with his peers through the treatment classroom.

Both Mat and his mom are proud of the progress they have made and the stronger relationship they have built. Mat now enjoys school and has additional classroom supports while he waits for placement in an Autism Spectrum Disorder Classroom. The family is truly thankful for the skills and strategies they learned at Vanier. Mat is on the right path for a bright future.

Crisis and Intake: 319-433-0334
CET is a partnership between Vanier Children's Mental Wellness, Craigmood Children, Youth and Family Services, and VOXS Mental Health Support.

If you or a young person you know is struggling, please reach out for help. We are here for you 24/7, 365 days per year. We listen. We advocate. We champion children to find their victories every day.

Caring. Supporting. Transforming Lives.

For more information about Vanier visit our website: www.vanier.com

vanier
Children's Mental Wellness

**MADAME VANIER
FOR CHILDREN'S
SERVICES
A KA VANIER CH
ILD
Pres**

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CIO SATURDAY, JANUARY 28, 2023 LONDON FREE PRESS

MENTAL HEALTH MATTERS

ADVERTISEMENT

Vanier Children's Mental Wellness

Vanier Children's Mental Wellness is a not-for-profit organization which has been serving children and families in London, Middlesex and Southwestern Ontario for over 50 years. Vanier provides system leadership and planning in the designated Child and Youth Mental Health Lead Agency for Middlesex County.

Vanier offers a range of services for children up to 18 years old and their families. Services are designed to offer support to families who have a child struggling with social, emotional, behavioural and mental health issues. Services are offered in London and in rural Middlesex communities (Stratford, Perth, Kitchener, Guelph, and London). Most of the services are supported through provincial funding and are offered at no cost to the family. Individual treatment plans are reviewed with families in a collaborative manner to meet their needs. Vanier offers a spectrum of services that vary in intensity, location, and program goals. Vanier is funded through the Ministry of Health and is accredited by the Canadian Centre for Accreditation, and is a member of Children's Mental Health Ontario (CMHO).

Vanier employs highly-skilled healthcare professionals including Psychiatrists, Psychologists, Child and Family Therapists, Nurses, Dietitians, Occupational Therapists, Speech Language Therapists and Child and Youth Counsellors.

Timothy (Chris and Isabel) is the front door to access services at Vanier. Services offered include crisis support, family therapy, groups, workshops, day respite, in-home counselling, specialized services and School Community Intervention Partnership (SCIP) programs. In addition, Vanier provides drop-in services including Talk-In and PAIR Clinic.

Vanier is the host for the Talk-In Mental Health Services West-ern Hub. The Mental Health is a strategic solution for increasing access to child psychiatry and reducing wait times for children and youth in rural, remote and underserved communities. Talk-In Mental Health is a consultation model with access to specialized mental health services provided by three hubs: The Hospital for Sick Children, the Children's Hospital of Eastern Ontario, and Vanier Children's Mental Wellness.

In addition, Vanier offers intensive and live-in treatment for children designed to reduce the severity of mental health challenges, strengthen coping and resilience, and improve functioning at home, at school and in the community. The goal is always to work with the family to transition the child home. Vanier also understands in-

Intensive services are sometimes required by families, and it delivers by providing intensive in-home counselling, treatment classrooms, out-of-home treatment, family therapy and a list of specialized services.

In October 2023, Vanier partnered with Children's Hospital at L39C to launch a Canadian first intensive eating disorders program. The day treatment program supports clients up to age 18. This is a brand new, high-intensity eating disorders program with a focus on recovery, and it accommodates the transition of clients who meet the admission criteria from Children's Hospital to Vanier's program.

A dedicated waiver at Vanier, Cottage 43, named HUBTEX - an acronym for Healing, Acceptance, Care, Vision, Engagement, Nourishment - is leveraged with Ministry of Health-funded beds, kitchen, living and dining room, washrooms, therapy clinic room and furniture where all spaces and furniture are aligned within an environment conducive to healing and recovery.

For more information on Vanier and its mental services and programs, visit www.vanier.com. For those in crisis or looking for immediate support, call 319-433-0334.

vanier
Children's Mental Wellness

vanier
Children's Mental Wellness

We listen. We advocate.
We champion children to find their victories every day.
We support the family, the central part of a successful outcome.
We help put the pieces together.
Caring. Supporting. Transforming Lives.
www.vanier.com

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